

An attachment is *not an archive.*

Invoice Capture and expenses store their receipts as attachments in Dynamics 365. Convenient — and not an archive. How standard attachments are archived by rule: copy or move, never delete on error.

Forty thousand expense receipts. *In the database.*

Photographed, uploaded, reimbursed. Subject to retention. Unarchived. Nobody decided that — the standard attaches files to the record, and the standard has no archive. Only a table that grows.

Where the process needs it. Where retention *needs it*.

An attachment has no document type, no references beyond the record, no permissions of its own. Whoever may change the record may swap it. And it sits in a database not built for ten years of images.

Per table.

Per document type.

Table	vendor invoice, expense line, sales order
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Document type	internal or external, from the FlexxStore list
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Form configuration	metadata from the record
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Condition, file types	only what meets the filter
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Delete only when *archived*.

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- 01 Copy: attachment stays in the ERP, archive gets the copy
 - 02 Move: attachment is deleted — after state “archived”
 - 03 Never at “pending”, never at “error”
 - 04 Switching does not act retroactively
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Skip. Log. *Carry on.*

A corrupt file does not stop the batch. The failure is in the log: file name, table, record. Every deletion likewise. Whoever wants to know where an attachment went reads it up.

The expense receipt is in the archive.

With document type and permissions.

The backup gets smaller.

Not larger.

Invoice Capture notices nothing.

The copy is enough.

Convenient is *not retained.*

FlexxStore — the ECM solution for Dynamics 365 — archives standard attachments by rule, copies or moves, and never deletes what did not arrive. Built by the Soluvine development team I have worked with since Damgaard.

Configurable	fitted to the process, not the other way round
30-day trial	no obligation
Microsoft AppSource	all solutions available there — soluvine.com
The full post	restless365.com/post-an-attachment-is-not-an-archive

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